The CESSDA Vocabulary Service:

A New State-of-the-Art Tool for Creating and Publishing Controlled Terms Lists

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CREATION

Combined effort between four CESSDA service providers — UKDS, FSD, GESIS and SND — in collaboration with the DDI Alliance.

All partners worked closely together to define the requirements, create wireframes, develop and test the tool.

CAPACITY

Supports management of controlled vocabularies for use in the CESSDA Data Catalogue, Euro Question Bank, and other CESSDA products.

Increases CESSDA's capacity to support metadata production and refinement.

FUNCTIONALITY

Facilitates entire CV workflow from creation to review, publication and updates, translations.

Supports CVs translation and publication into all CESSDA member languages.

Collaborative CVs management: Web-based, accessible interface.

General users can view all published CVs.

Automated versioning, including separate versioning system for translations. Each translation is based on the source language version.

Export formats: SKOS, HTML, PDF

IMPACT

The tool will be used to store and manage the CVs used by CESSDA for its products, and by the DDI Alliance.

It will publicize the work of the DDI Alliance and its collaboration with CESSDA, jointly raising the profile of both organizations.

The development issues tackled within this project such as versioning, multilinguality, export, and roles will benefit other upcoming tools and products.

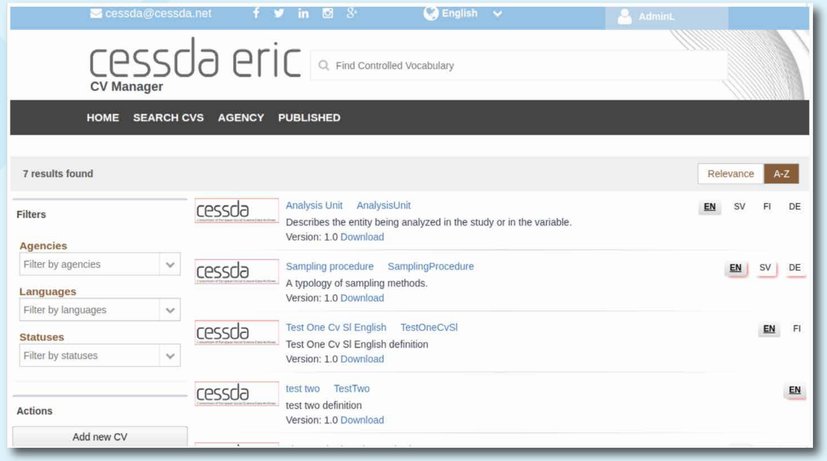
USER EXPERIENCE

Extensive testing has been carried out by both the project team and members of the DDI Alliance in order to ensure usability of the tool.

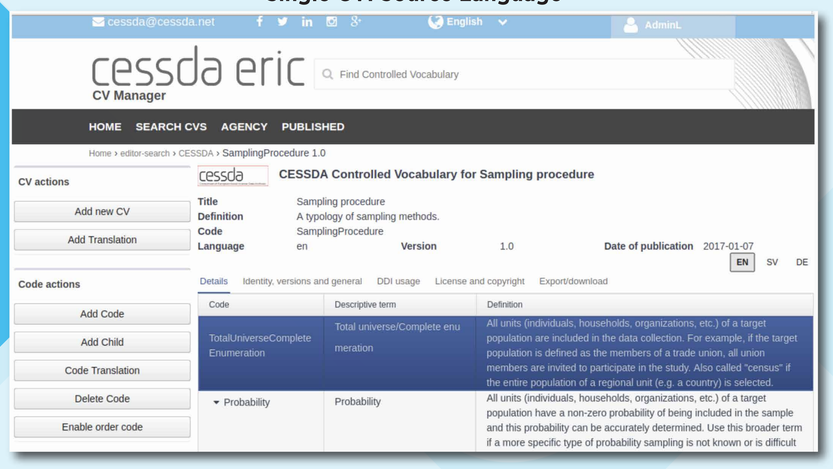
A user guide is provided and feedback will continue to be sought after public release, as a basis for future enhancements.

FIRST RELEASE: APRIL 2019

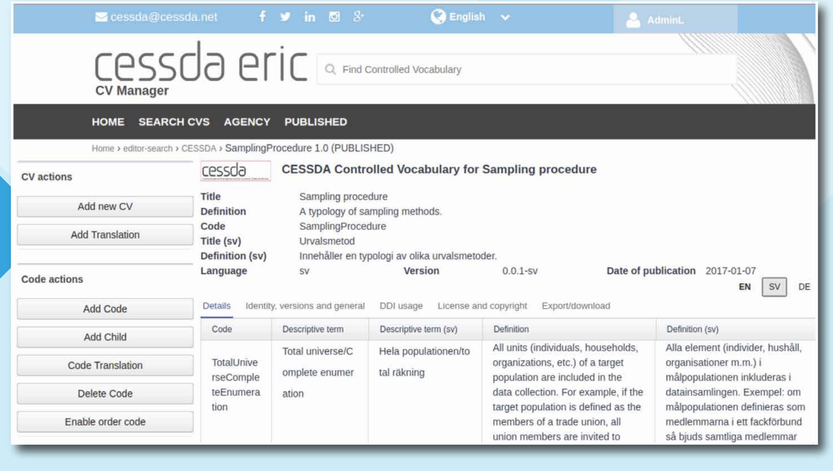
CVs Search: Editor View



Single CV: Source Language



Single CV: Translation



Controlled Vocabularies Working Group of the DDI Alliance (DDI_CVG)

- Active since 2007, meets monthly
- Multinational/multicultural group contributing experiences from a diversity of data archives and socio-political environments
- Current members represent ICPSR (USA), ADA (Australia), and several European data archives: UKDS (UK), GESIS (Germany), NSD (Norway), FSD (Finland), and SND (Sweden)

23 vocabularies issued to date

- Self-standing products
- May be used with DDI-C, DDI-L as well as other documentation standards, or formats
- Currently published and maintained by the DDI-CVG on the DDI Alliance website
- Issued in US English only — translations not supported
- Formats available for browsing and downloads: Genericode-XML, Excel, HTML
- Production and publication processes are mostly manual: time-consuming and error-prone

CESSDA Metadata Management (CMM) Project

- Develop a Metadata Standards Portfolio to support resource discovery and question banks
- The Porfolio: DDI compliant; will include a core standardized metadata model and controlled vocabularies for relevant fields.
- Controlled vocabularies — a crucial part of the new CESSDA metadata standard
- CESSDA to use DDI Alliance controlled vocabularies if available